enCounter

USER GUIDE

Alpha 3 — Run / Prepare Workspace, Compendium, Recovery & Portable Builds

Version 0.3.0-alpha.1 • MIT License • Alpha / Pre-release

IMPORTANT: This guide documents enCounter v0.3.0-alpha.1, an Alpha / pre-release build. Export important data before upgrading. Screenshots in this guide reflect the Alpha 3 interface and may change in later pre-release builds.

This guide covers installation, the Alpha 3 Run / Prepare workflow, Character Library, D&D 5E SRD Compendium, reusable encounter templates and saved states, initiative and Active Turn controls, Conditions, Exhaustion, Recovery and Death Saves, Player Display, Scene/Combat presentation, Timer, Soundscape and Sound Cues, backups, portable builds, and safe shutdown.

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1. About enCounter and Alpha 3

enCounter is a local-first TTRPG encounter, initiative, scene-presentation, timer, audio, and Player Display manager. The DM Console is used to prepare reusable content and run live encounters; a separate Player Display can be placed on a second monitor or TV while DM-only controls remain private.

- Runs locally on the computer. Packaged Windows and Linux builds do not require Python on the target machine.
- Uses browser IndexedDB as the primary working database.
- Can write additional JSON backups into the portable enCounter folder.
- Supports Generic TTRPG, Star Wars Saga Edition (SWSE), D&D 5E, and a four-stat Custom profile.
- Supports reusable Players, NPCs, Enemies, Creatures, encounter templates, saved encounter states, local media assets, timers, Soundscapes, and recovery snapshots.
- Binds the local application server to 127.0.0.1 rather than exposing it as a public network service.

SINGLE DM CONSOLE: Use one DM Console window at a time. Multiple DM Console windows can write to the same browser database and the most recent save may replace earlier changes.

1.1 What changes in Alpha 3

- Run and Prepare are now separate workspaces.
- Quick Encounter provides a fast live-session path without first creating a reusable template.
- Prepare includes Characters, Compendium, Encounters, Assets, and Data & Tools.
- D&D 5E SRD creature search can add creatures directly to an encounter or save editable local copies to the Library.
- Active Turn now centralizes HP, Conditions, Exhaustion, Recovery, visibility, Defeated, and Return to Combat controls.
- D&D 5E Player combatants support Downed/Stable/Dead recovery and integrated death saves.
- Combatant rows are simplified for scanning; infrequent actions live in the ... menu.
- Portable build, launcher, browser security, and release-audit behavior have been hardened.

1.2 Updating from Alpha 2

1. In the old build, wait until the DM Console shows SAVED.
2. Open Data / Data & Tools and use Export Everything. Save the JSON outside the application folder.
3. Keep a separate copy of custom images/audio if they are important. JSON exports reference local media; they do not embed those files.
4. Use Exit enCounter. Do not replace application files while the local server is running.
5. Extract v0.3.0-alpha.1 into a new writable folder rather than copying it over the old installation.
6. Start the new build with the same browser profile normally used for enCounter.
7. Verify the version, Library, encounters, Player Display, and important custom media before deleting the old folder.

Do not clear site data or IndexedDB as part of a routine upgrade.

2. Downloading and Installing

2.1 Windows portable release

1. Download the Windows portable ZIP and its published SHA-256 checksum from the matching release.
2. Verify the checksum when practical.
3. Right-click the ZIP and choose Extract All.
4. Extract to a normal writable location such as Documents, Desktop, or a dedicated Games/Tools folder.
5. Open the extracted folder and double-click enCounter.exe.

WRITABLE FOLDER REQUIRED: Do not place the portable build under Program Files unless you intentionally manage permissions there. enCounter writes backups, imports, caches, and user assets inside its portable folder.

2.2 Linux portable release

1. Download the Linux archive and checksum from the matching release.
2. Extract the complete archive into a writable folder under your home directory.
3. Run the enCounter executable. If your desktop does not mark it executable, run chmod +x enCounter in a terminal.
4. Start it with ./enCounter if double-click launch is not available.

ARCHITECTURE: Linux portable packages are architecture-specific. Use the release that matches the target system.

2.3 Portable folder structure

Keep the complete extracted portable folder together. The executable depends on the accompanying _internal, programs, assets, data, and docs folders.

Item	Purpose
enCounter.exe / enCounter	Packaged local launcher/server.
_internal/	PyInstaller runtime files required by the executable.
programs/	Application HTML/CSS/JavaScript and launcher resources.
assets/	Branding plus user portrait/background/audio folders.
data/	Backups, exports/imports, and local Compendium cache.
docs/	User Guide, legal notices, version information, and release notes.
LICENSE / README / notices	Project license and release documentation.

3. Starting enCounter and Startup Recovery

Starting enCounter launches a local HTTP server on 127.0.0.1:5500 and opens the DM Console in the default browser. The packaged launcher is local-only and is not intended to accept remote network clients.

1. Start the packaged executable from the extracted release folder.
2. Wait for the default browser to open the DM Console.
3. Confirm the header reports ALPHA · v0.3.0-alpha.1.
4. If a recovery prompt appears, choose whether to resume the prior live encounter/timer state or begin a new encounter.

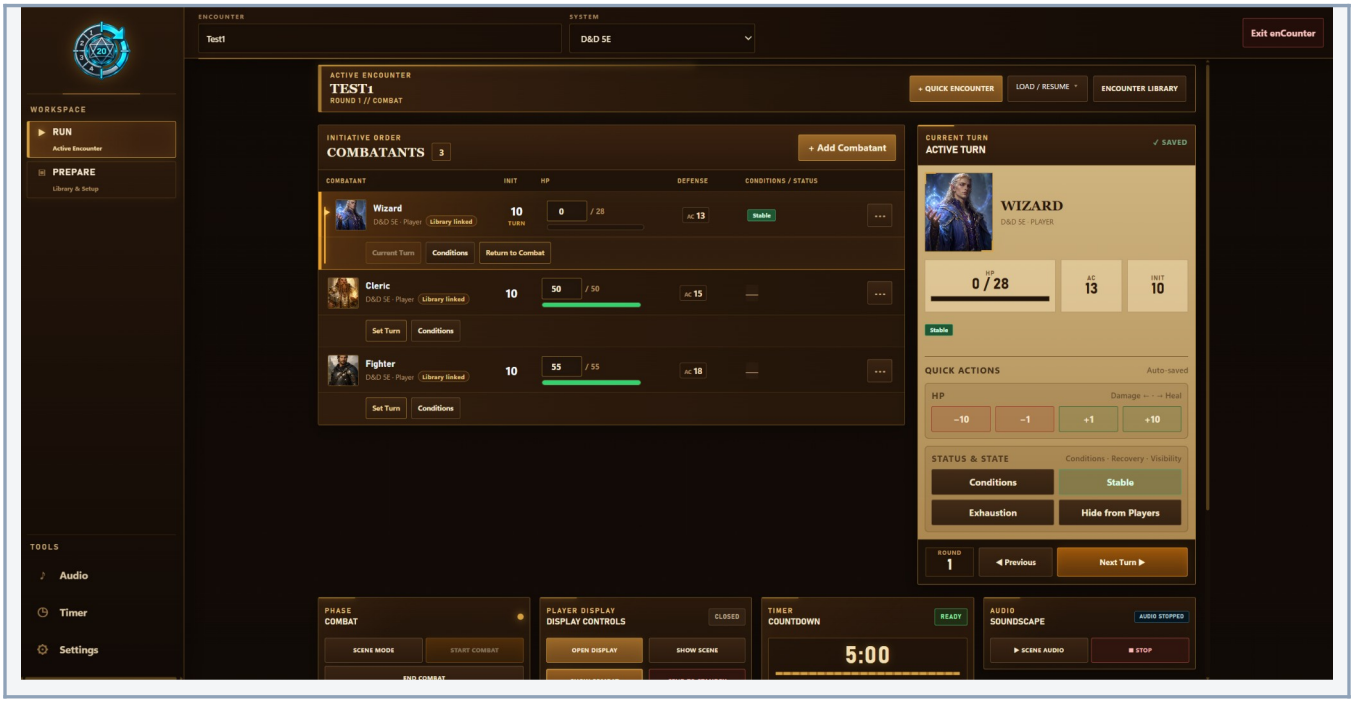


Figure 1 — Alpha 3 DM Console on first launch.

3.1 Duplicate launch behavior

If a compatible enCounter server is already running on port 5500, launching the packaged executable again is handled gracefully rather than starting a second competing server. A second browser tab/window may open, but the original server remains the active local instance.

3.2 Startup recovery

enCounter can retain the active encounter and a separate runtime timer checkpoint for restart recovery. Beginning a new encounter does not delete the permanent Library, reusable encounter templates, saved encounter states, assets, settings, or recovery snapshots.

4. Alpha 3 DM Console Overview

4.1 Header

Control	Purpose
Encounter	Names the active Run encounter.
System	Selects Generic, SWSE, D&D 5E, or Custom for the active encounter.
Version	Displays the Alpha build version.
Exit enCounter	Performs the application shutdown workflow and releases the local server.

4.2 Workspace navigation

Area	Purpose
RUN — Active Encounter	Live encounter, initiative, Active Turn, display controls, timer, and Sound Cues.
PREPARE — Library & Setup	Characters, Compendium, Encounters, Assets, and Data & Tools.
Audio	Detailed Soundscape configuration and preview.
Timer	Detailed timer configuration and preview.
Settings	System mode/module and application settings.

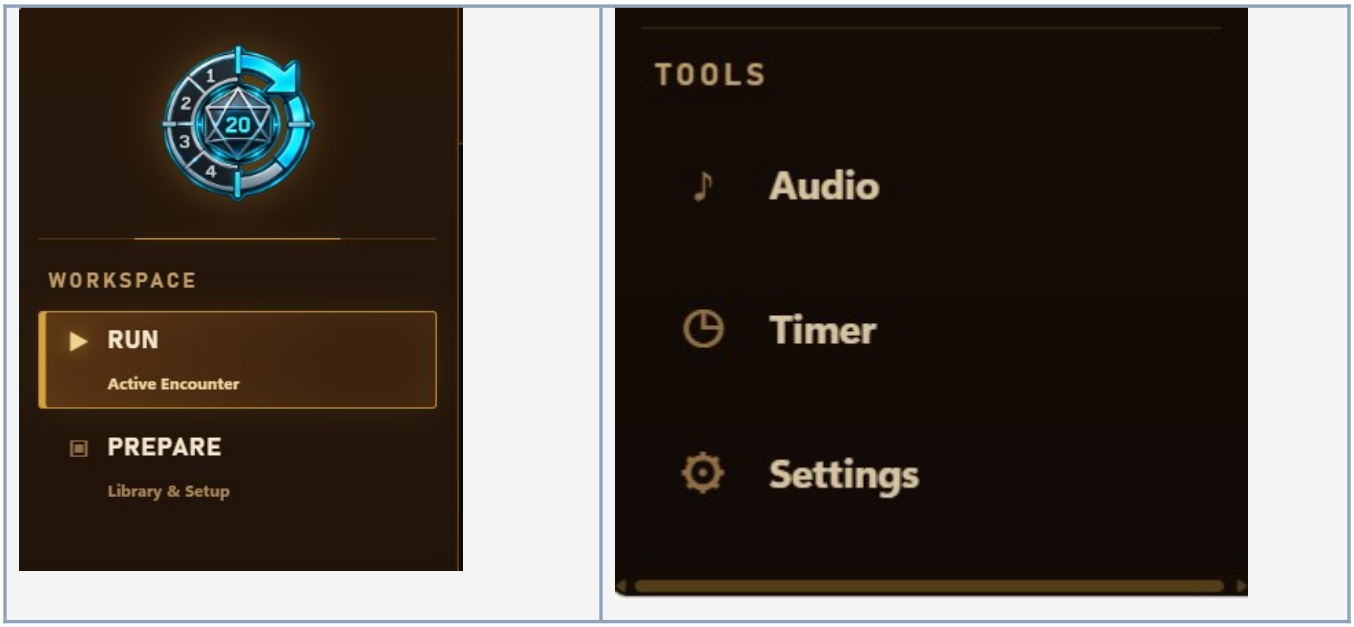


Figure 2 — Run / Prepare workspace navigation.

5. Settings and System Profiles

Settings controls which game-system labels and optional combat modules are shown. Existing Alpha settings are normalized when loaded.

System	Typical key stats / behavior
Generic TTRPG	Defense, Perception, Speed.
Star Wars Saga Edition	REF, FORT, WILL, Perception, Speed, plus Condition Track behavior.
D&D 5E	AC and D&D-specific structured Conditions, Exhaustion, and Recovery/Death Save support.
Custom	Four configurable stat labels defined by the DM.

Tracker modes may expose different modules. If a module is manually changed, the configuration can become Custom so the exact module selection is preserved.

SYSTEM MATCHING: Library pickers only show entries compatible with the active encounter system. Changing an encounter system later does not convert existing combatants to another system profile.

6. Prepare → Characters

Character Library stores permanent reusable Players, NPCs, Enemies, and Creatures. Adding a Library entry to Run creates an encounter copy; ordinary live damage and status changes do not rewrite the permanent Library record.

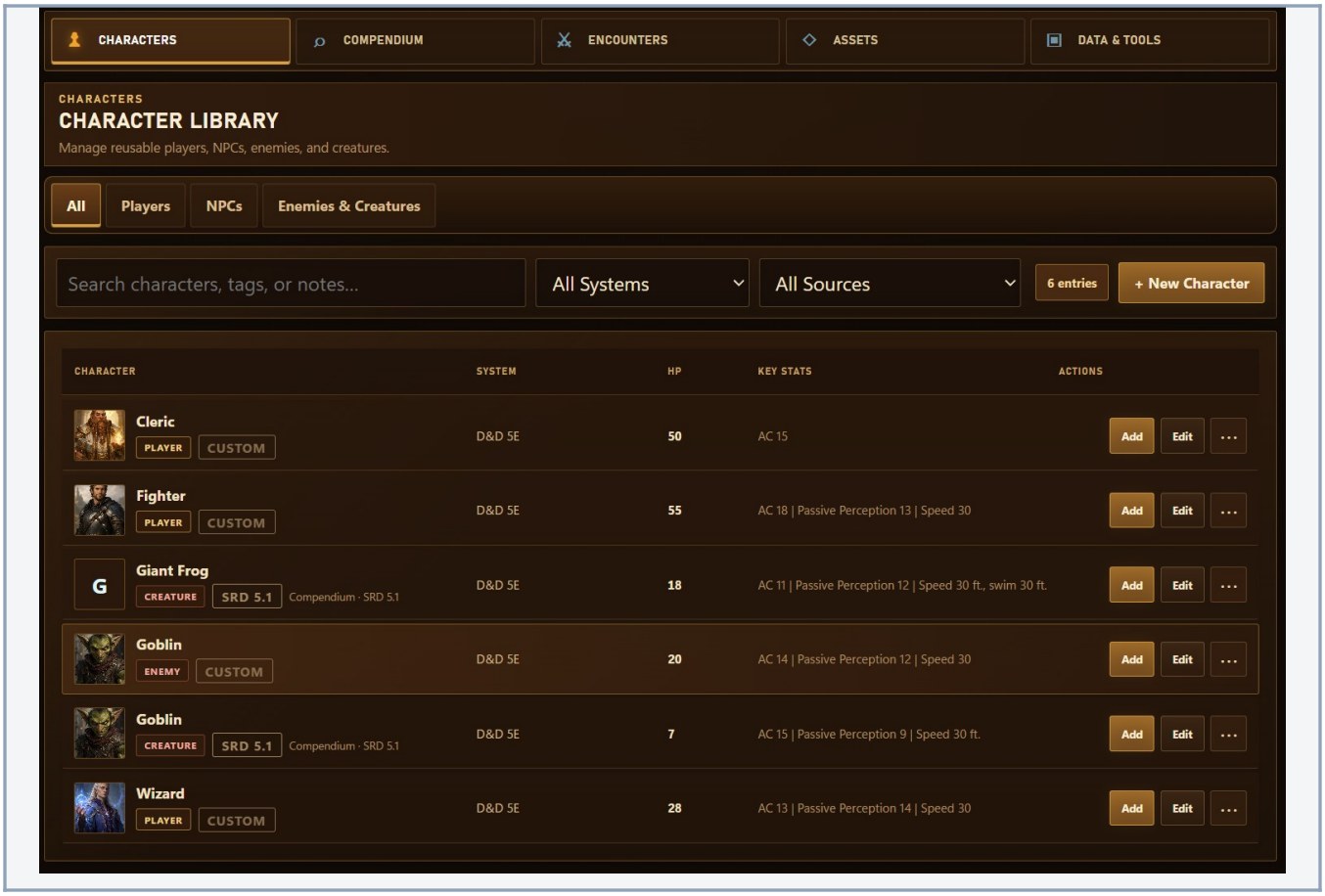


Figure 3 — Prepare → Characters / Character Library.

6.1 Create or edit a Library entry

1. Open Prepare → Characters.
2. Click + New Character, or choose Edit on an existing entry.
3. Enter Name, Type, and System.
4. Enter Maximum HP and system-specific stats as required.
5. Choose/import a portrait if desired.
6. Add searchable tags and private DM notes as needed.
7. Save the Library entry.

6.2 Search and filters

- Category: All, Players, NPCs, Enemies & Creatures.
- System: Generic, SWSE, D&D 5E, Custom.
- Source: All Sources, Custom, Compendium (SRD 5.1).
- Search: name, tags, and notes.

6.3 Updating portraits and linked combatants

When a permanent Library record is updated, linked active encounter copies can be refreshed/synchronized by stable Library ID or Compendium identity. This allows portrait or permanent-data updates to reach an already-added combatant without requiring removal and re-addition.

COMPENDIUM ENTRIES: A locally saved Compendium creature remains an editable Library record. DM-owned portrait/notes customization is preserved when SRD mechanics are refreshed where the current workflow supports it.

7. Prepare → Compendium

Alpha 3 includes an online D&D 5E SRD creature provider. Creature data is sourced from the D&D System Reference Document 5.1 through the D&D 5e SRD API maintained by the 5e-bits project. The current provider is SRD 2014 monster data.

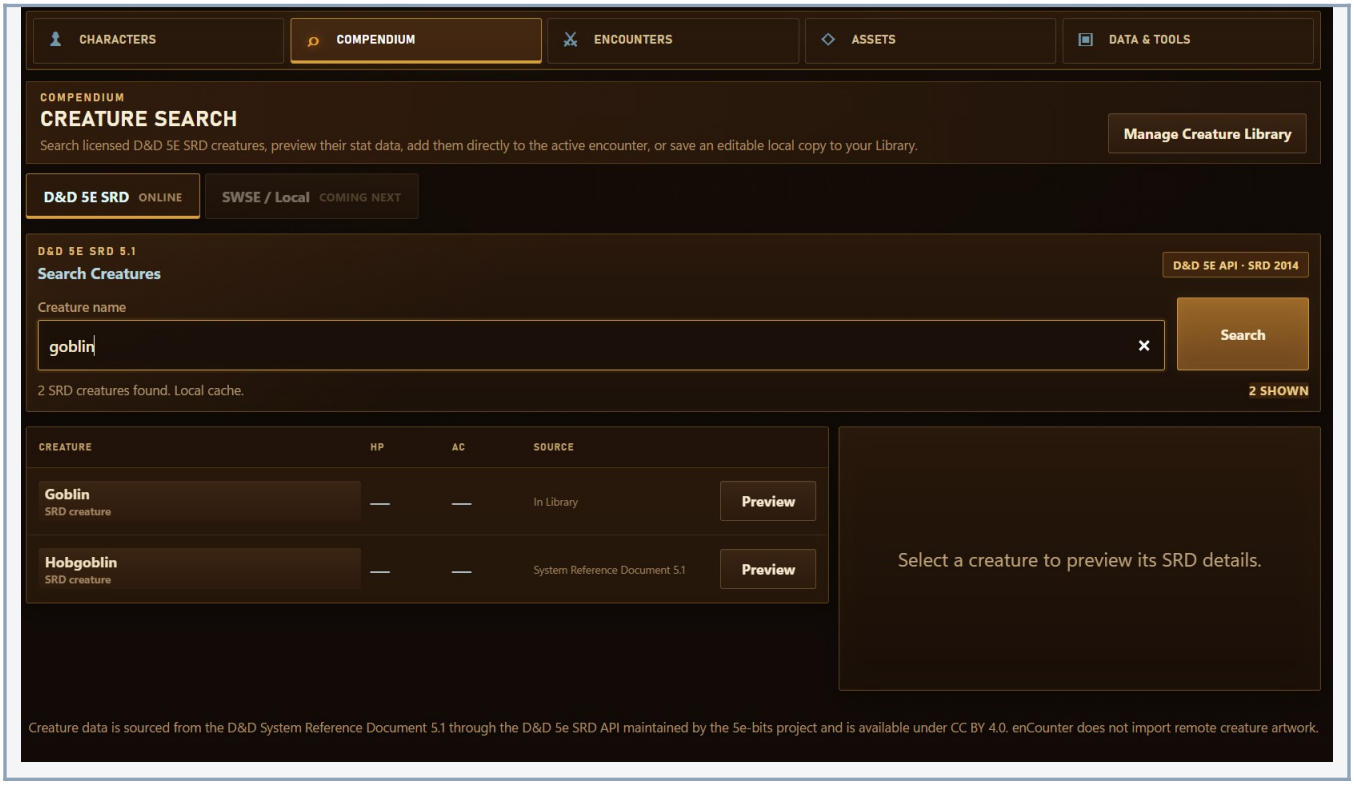


Figure 4 — Prepare → Compendium / D&D 5E SRD search.

7.1 Search for a creature

1. Open Prepare → Compendium.
2. Enter a creature name, for example goblin, skeleton, or dragon.
3. Click Search or press Enter.
4. Select a result to inspect the available SRD stat data.

7.2 Add directly to the active encounter

1. Choose Add to Encounter from the selected creature result/preview.
2. Enter or accept the initiative value.
3. enCounter adds the creature to the active encounter and returns to Run.

Multiple copies of the same SRD creature may be added to one encounter. Provider identity prevents this from overwriting the permanent Library record.

7.3 Save or refresh a local Library copy

Save to Library creates an editable local record. If the same provider/key already exists in the Library, the workflow refreshes the existing Compendium-linked record rather than relying only on the creature name.

7.4 Artwork policy

NO REMOTE ARTWORK IMPORT: enCounter does not import remote creature artwork from the Compendium provider. Assign a portrait from your own local assets to the saved Library entry if desired.

Refreshing a Compendium creature is designed to preserve DM-owned Library customization such as a local portrait and notes while updating source mechanics.

7.5 Compendium cache and availability

Search/index/detail information can be cached locally under the portable data/cache/compendium folder when available. Internet access is still required when requested data is not already cached. The launcher restricts the direct browser fallback connection to the configured D&D 5E API origin.

8. Prepare → Encounters

Prepare → Encounters separate reusable pre-game setup from saved live-session state.

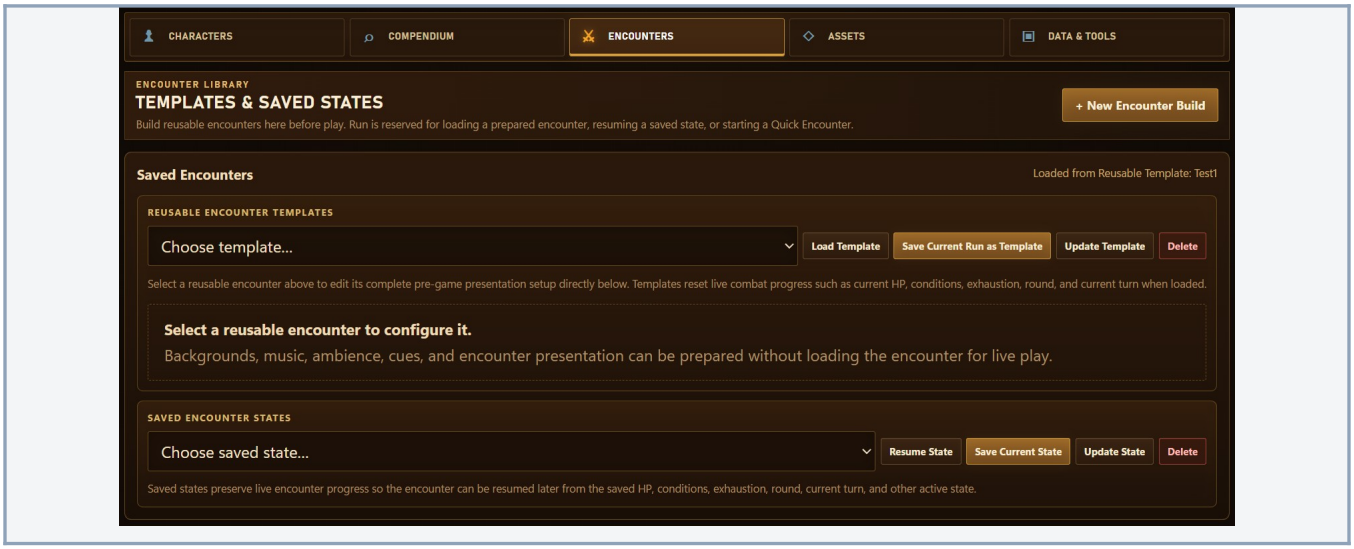


Figure 5 — Prepare → Encounters / Templates & Saved States.

8.1 Reusable Encounter Templates

Templates are designed to be loaded as fresh encounters. They preserve prepared roster/presentation configuration while resetting transient live combat progress such as current HP, conditions, Exhaustion, round, current turn, and similar runtime state as appropriate.

Action	Purpose
Load Template	Loads a fresh working copy into Run.
Save Current Run as Template	Intentionally turns the current live encounter into a reusable template.
Update Template	Updates the selected reusable template.
Delete	Deletes the selected template after confirmation.

8.2 Saved Encounter States

Saved Encounter States preserve live progress for resuming a session. Use these when the next session should continue from the current HP, recovery/status, turn, round, and other saved runtime state rather than reset to a fresh template.

> **TEMPLATE VS STATE:** Use a Template for repeatable encounter setup. Use a Saved Encounter State to resume the specific live situation you left off with.

8.3 Direct pre-game setup editor

Select a reusable template to edit its setup directly in Prepare without loading it into the live Run encounter. The editor provides Save Encounter Setup status feedback.

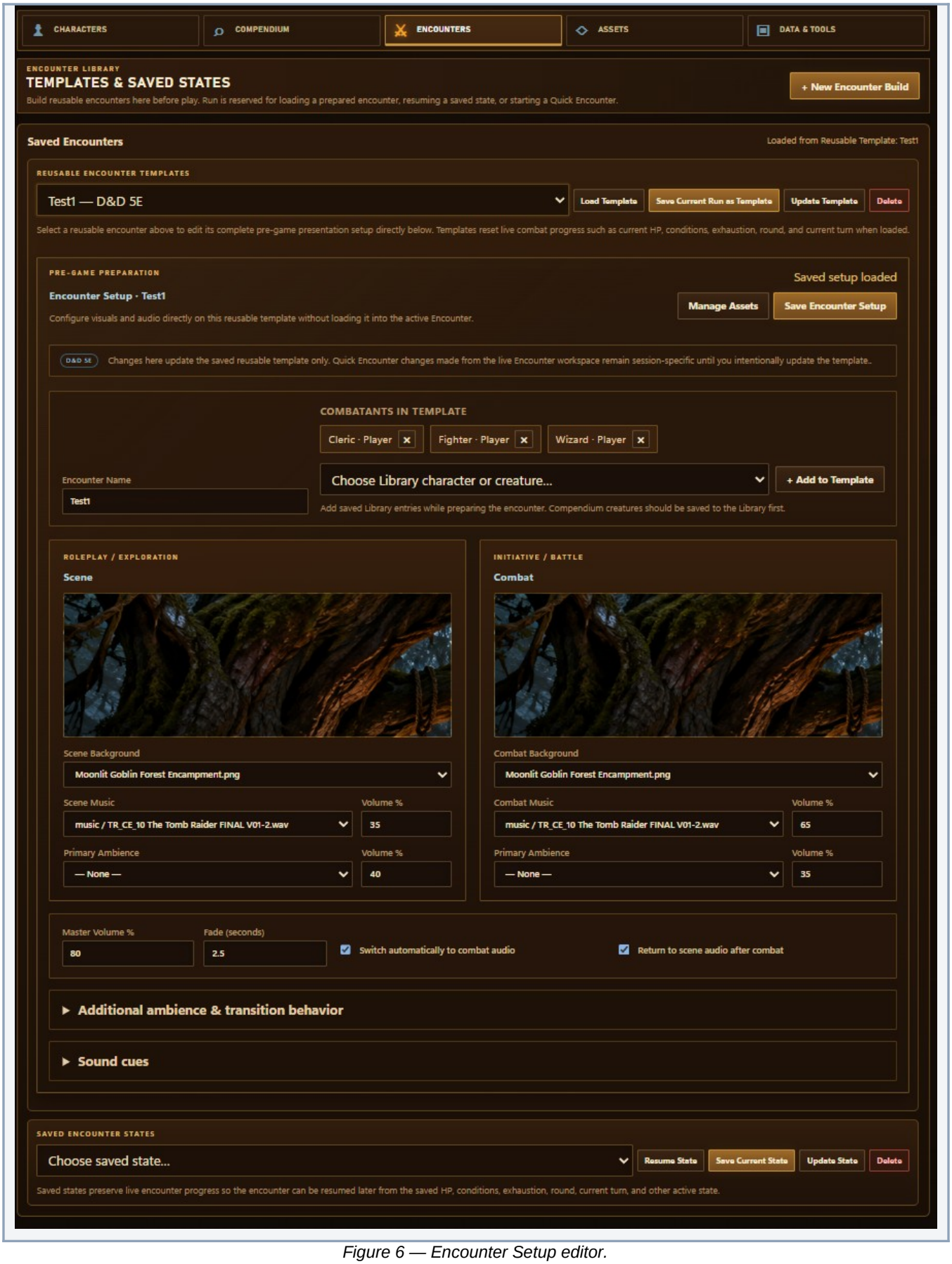
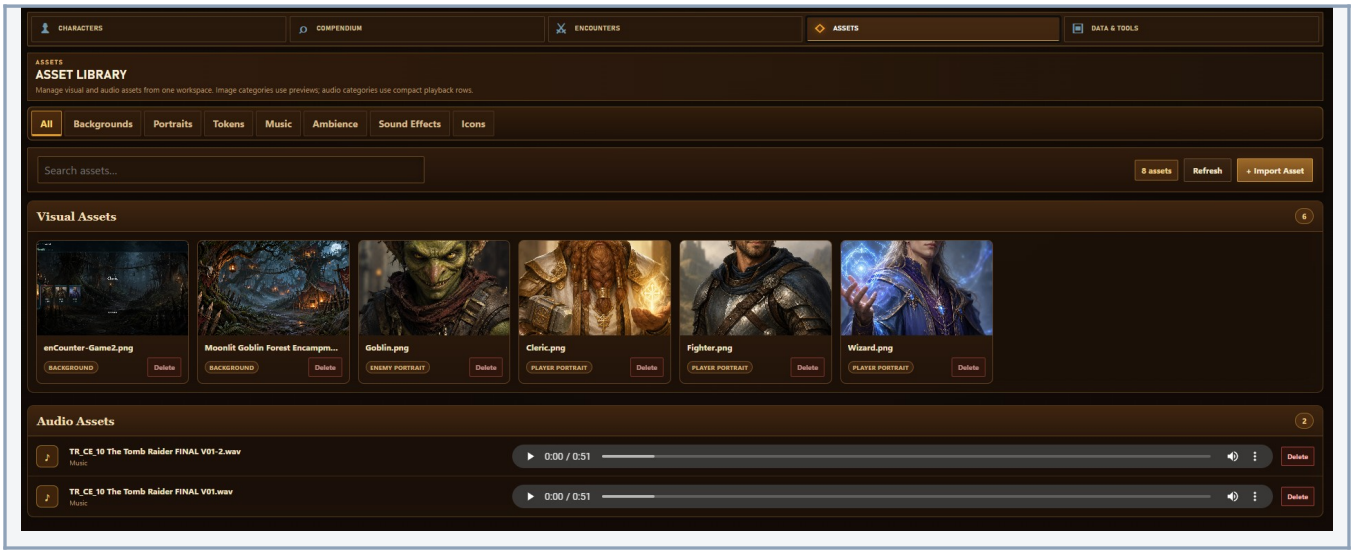


Figure 6 — Encounter Setup editor.

- Add saved Library combatants to the template.
- Choose Scene background and Combat background.
- Configure Scene music/ambience and Combat music/ambience.
- Configure transition/fade behavior and Sound Cues.
- Configure prepared Timer settings.
- Save the setup directly to the reusable template.

9. Prepare → Assets

Assets manages reusable portraits, backgrounds, icons/tokens, and local audio files supported by the application. The UI can import supported files into the portable assets folder and refresh the available list.



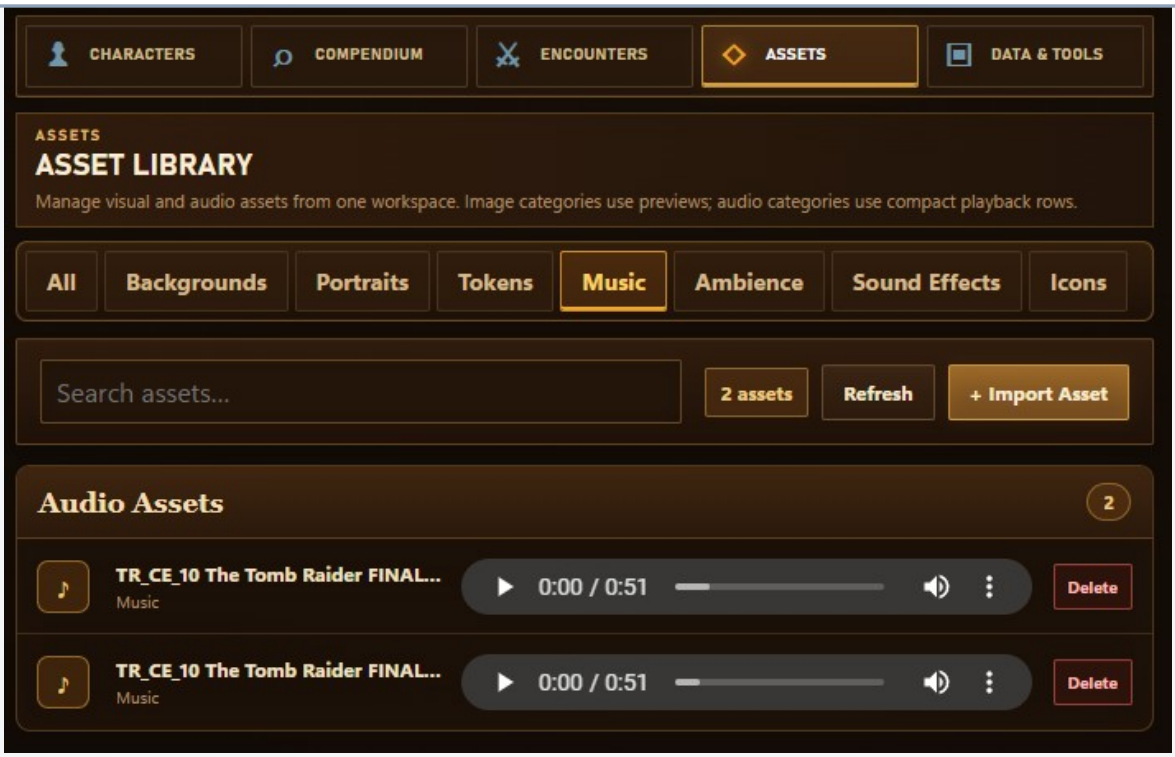


Figure 7 — Prepare → Assets.

Asset type	Typical location
Player portraits	assets/portraits/players/
NPC portraits	assets/portraits/npcs/
Enemy portraits	assets/portraits/enemies/
Custom portraits	assets/portraits/custom/
Scene/Combat backgrounds	assets/backgrounds/...
Music	assets/sounds/music/
Ambience	assets/sounds/ambience/
Sound effects	assets/sounds/sfx/
Custom audio	assets/sounds/custom/

REFERENCES: Before destructive asset deletion, Alpha 3 checks broader references including templates, saved states, current Run encounter, and recovery snapshots where supported.

10. Prepare → Data & Tools

Data & Tools provides export, import, restore, recovery, and browser-storage functions. Browser IndexedDB remains the primary working database; disk backups/exports provide an additional recovery path.

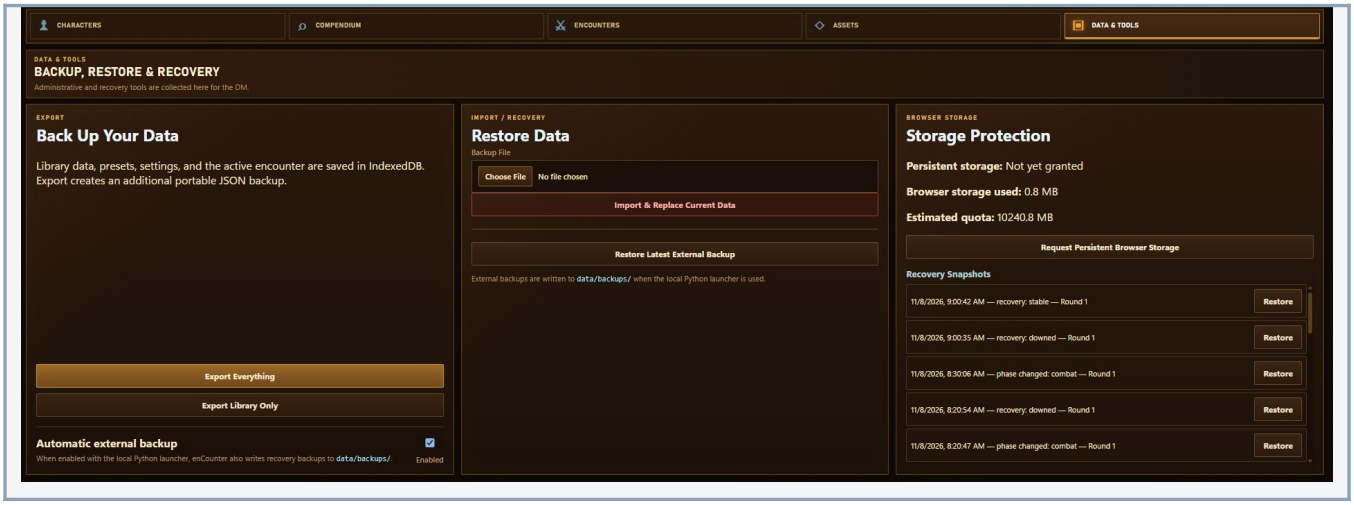


Figure 8 — Prepare → Data & Tools.

10.1 Export Everything

Use Export Everything before Alpha upgrades, before moving to another computer, and at important campaign/session milestones. Store at least one copy outside the enCounter application folder.

10.2 Recovery snapshots

enCounter creates recovery snapshots at key encounter transitions. Restoring a snapshot replaces the active encounter state but does not replace the permanent Library.

10.3 Persistent browser storage

Request Persistent Browser Storage asks the browser to reduce the chance of routine eviction. The browser decides whether to grant it. This is not a substitute for exports/backups.

11. Run → Active Encounter

Run is the live-game workspace. It is designed so the DM can manage initiative, active-combatant state, Player Display, timer, and Sound Cues without navigating away from the encounter.

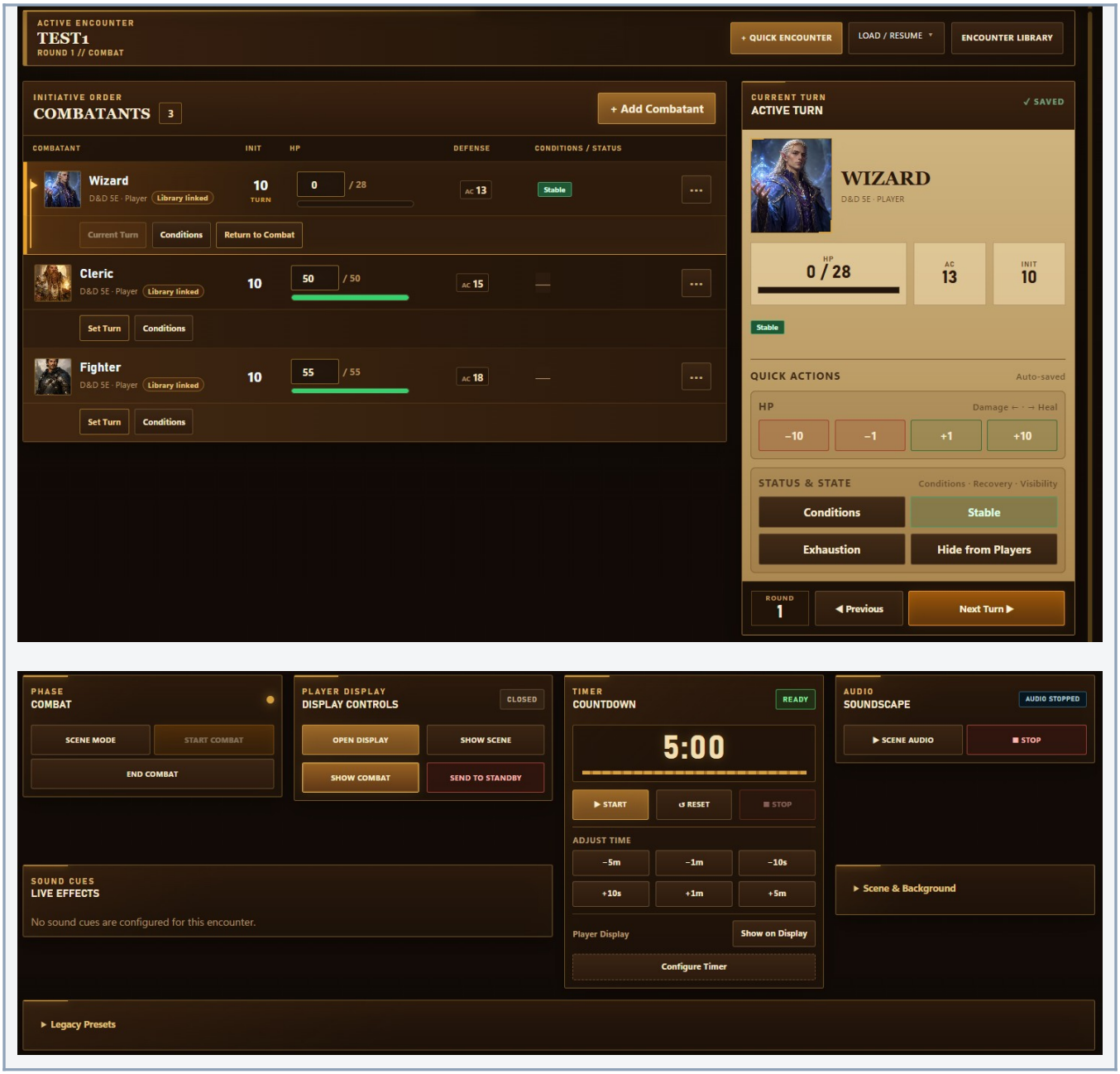


Figure 9 — Run → Active Encounter.

11.1 Start a Quick Encounter

1. Click + Quick Encounter.
2. Enter an encounter name when prompted.
3. Add combatants from the Library, Compendium, or Quick Create.
4. Use Run immediately; save it as a Template or Saved Encounter State only when you intentionally want persistence beyond the current live encounter.

11.2 Load or resume

- Reusable Template → Load Template: fresh prepared encounter.
- Saved Encounter State → Resume State: continue stored live progress.

12. Adding Combatants

Click + Add Combatant in the Run roster. Choose one source tab.

Source	Use when
Library	The combatant already exists as a reusable permanent record.
Compendium	You want to search the D&D 5E SRD and add a creature.
Quick Create	You need a temporary Player/NPC/Enemy/Creature for this encounter only.

12.1 Library

Choose a category, select the Library entry, enter initiative, and click Add to Encounter.

12.2 Compendium

Open Compendium Search, select a creature, and add it to the active encounter. You can also save the creature to the Library for future reuse.

12.3 Quick Create

Enter Name, Type, Initiative, and optional Max HP, then click Add Temporary. This does not create a permanent Library record.

13. Initiative and Active Turn

Start Combat establishes the normal initiative flow. Eligible combatants are sorted by initiative, the current combatant is highlighted, and the DM/Player Display use the same active-turn state.

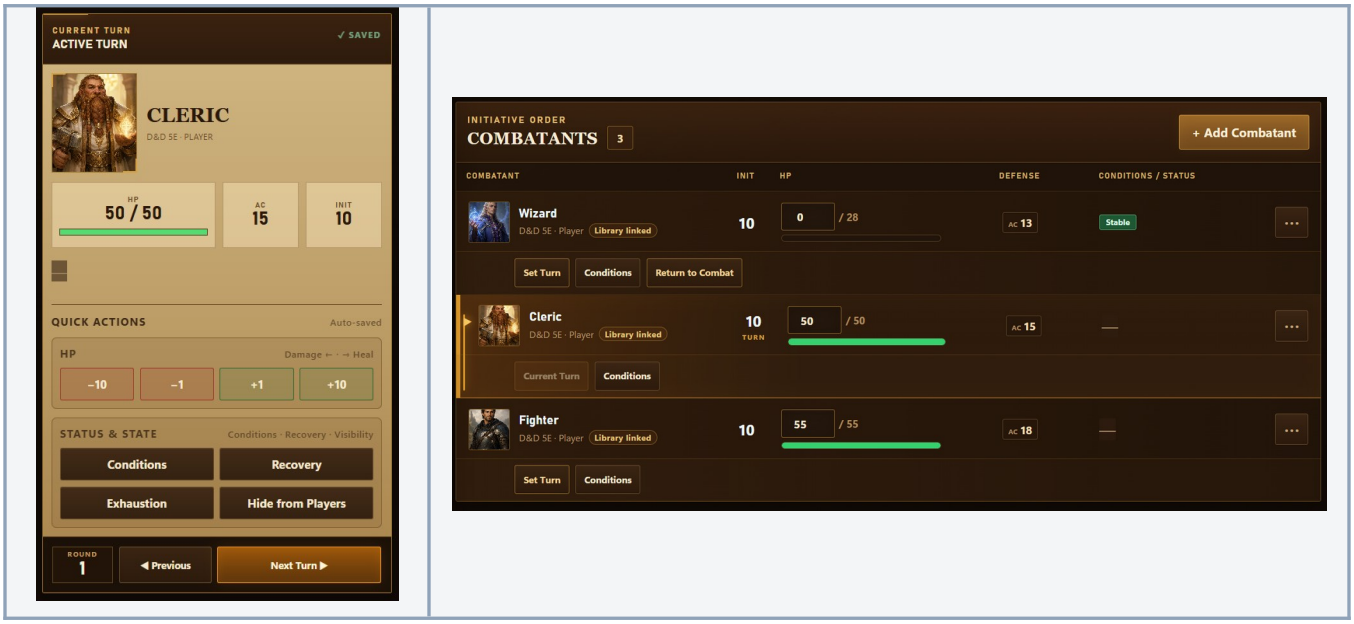


Figure 10 — Active Turn / Quick Actions.

13.1 Turn navigation

- Start Combat establishes the first active combatant.
- Next Turn advances through eligible initiative and advances the round when the order wraps.
- Previous moves backward through eligible initiative.
- Set Turn can make a selected combatant current.
- Trigger / Resume can return a Delayed/Readied combatant to the active turn when used.

13.2 DM Auto-Follow

When the active turn changes, enCounter scrolls the current combatant into view. Ordinary HP, status, resource, visibility, and notes edits do not trigger Auto-Follow so the DM can work on another combatant without the screen jumping away.

13.3 Active Turn Quick Actions

- HP: -10, -1, +1, +10.
- Conditions: structured Conditions/Status editor.
- Recovery: Downed/Stable/Dead/Return controls where supported.
- Exhaustion: D&D 5E level control when relevant.
- Visibility: Hide from Players / Reveal to Players.
- Defeated: removes the combatant from normal initiative without asserting death.

14. D&D 5E Conditions, Exhaustion, Recovery, and Death Saves

14.1 Conditions

D&D 5E combatants can hold multiple structured conditions at the same time. The current list is Blinded, Charmed, Deafened, Frightened, Grappled, Incapacitated, Invisible, Paralyzed, Petrified, Poisoned, Prone, Restrained, Stunned, and Unconscious.

Conditions appear as statuses in the DM Console and as player-visible badges when the combatant itself is visible to players.

14.2 Exhaustion

D&D 5E Exhaustion is stored separately from ordinary conditions and supports levels 0 through 6. Use the Conditions/Status editor or Active Turn Exhaustion control as available.

14.3 Recovery states

State	Meaning in enCounter
Normal	No special recovery state.
Downed	At 0 HP / in recovery; D&D Player characters can make death saves.

Stable	At 0 HP but no longer accumulating death-save successes/failures unless damaged again.
Dead	Removed from normal participation until explicitly returned by the DM.
Defeated	Encounter-removal state separate from death/recovery.

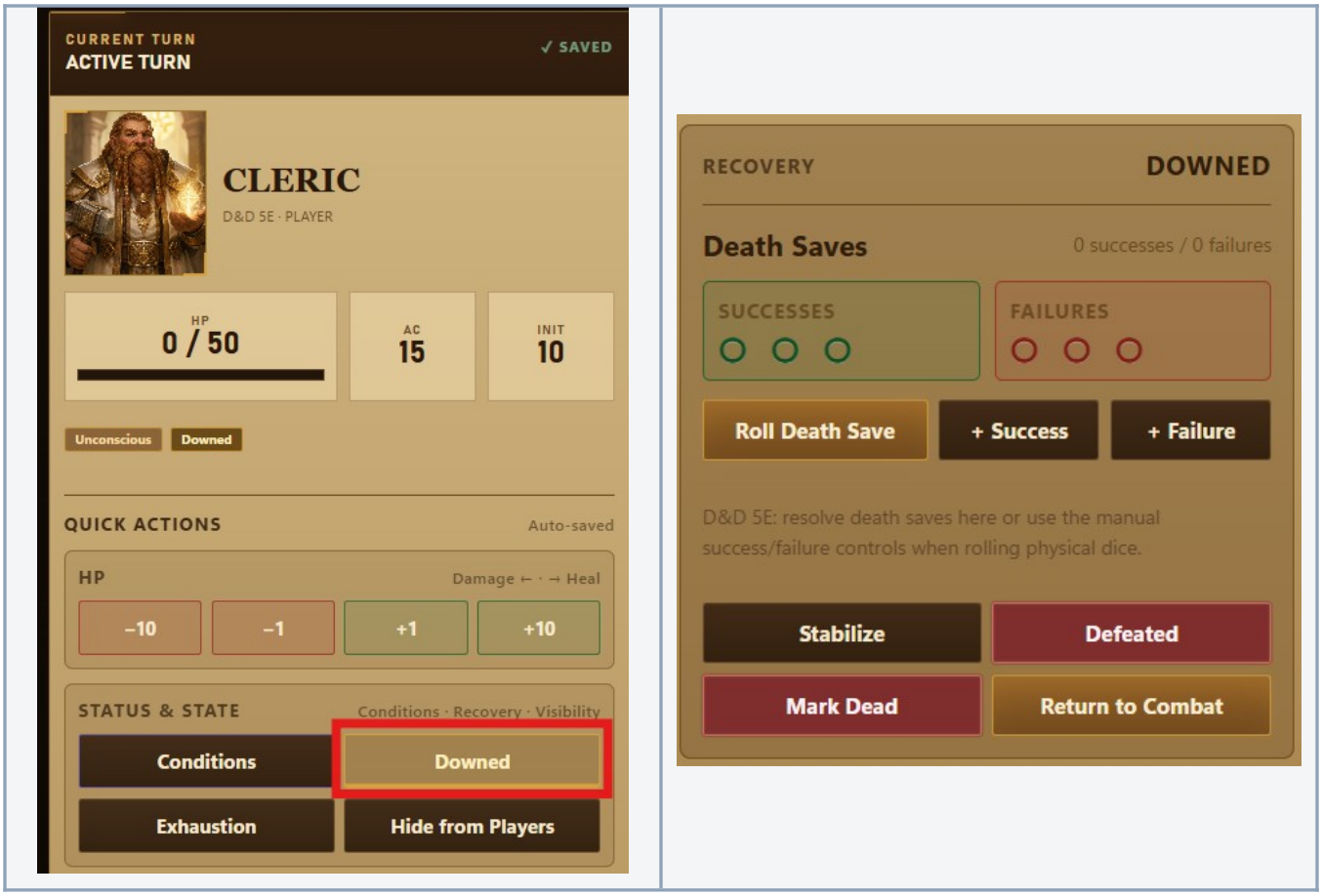


Figure 11 — Recovery and D&D 5E Death Saves.

14.4 Automatic D&D Player behavior at 0 HP

- A D&D 5E combatant with Type = Player that drops from above 0 HP to 0 HP automatically becomes Downed.
- Unconscious is added automatically.
- Death-save counters reset when entering a new Downed state.
- NPCs/enemies are not automatically forced into death-save bookkeeping; the DM controls their state.

14.5 Death Save rules implemented by enCounter

Result	enCounter action
Natural 20	Regain 1 HP; return to Normal; clear death saves and

	Unconscious.
10–19	Add 1 success.
2–9	Add 1 failure.
Natural 1	Add 2 failures.
3 successes	Set Stable.
3 failures	Set Dead.
Damage at 0 HP	Add 1 failure; add another manually when the hit should count for an additional failure.

Manual + Success and + Failure buttons can be used when the death save is rolled physically or when the DM needs to correct/record an external result.

14.6 Healing and Return to Combat

Healing a Downed or Stable combatant above 0 HP returns it to Normal and clears the D&D death-save state. A combatant marked Dead requires the explicit Return to Combat workflow.

14.7 SWSE recovery

Alpha 3 provides manual recovery-state support for SWSE. Marking an SWSE combatant Downed sets the Condition Track to Helpless. Returning a Helpless combatant to combat moves it to -10 when applicable. Detailed automated SWSE recovery checks are not part of this release.

15. Combatant States: Delay, Ready, Defeated, Hidden, and Return to Combat

The simplified roster moves less-frequent state changes to the combatant ... menu while keeping Active Turn controls prominent.

State/action	Behavior
Delay	Temporarily changes normal initiative participation until resumed.
Ready	Marks the combatant as readied until Trigger / Resume.
Defeated	Removes from normal initiative without implying death.
Downed / Stable / Dead	Recovery/life-state tracking; separate from Defeated.
Hide from Players	Combatant remains visible to the DM but is omitted from Player Display.
Reveal to Players	Restores player visibility.
Return to Combat	Restores a removed/recovery combatant and requests

	HP > 0 when required.

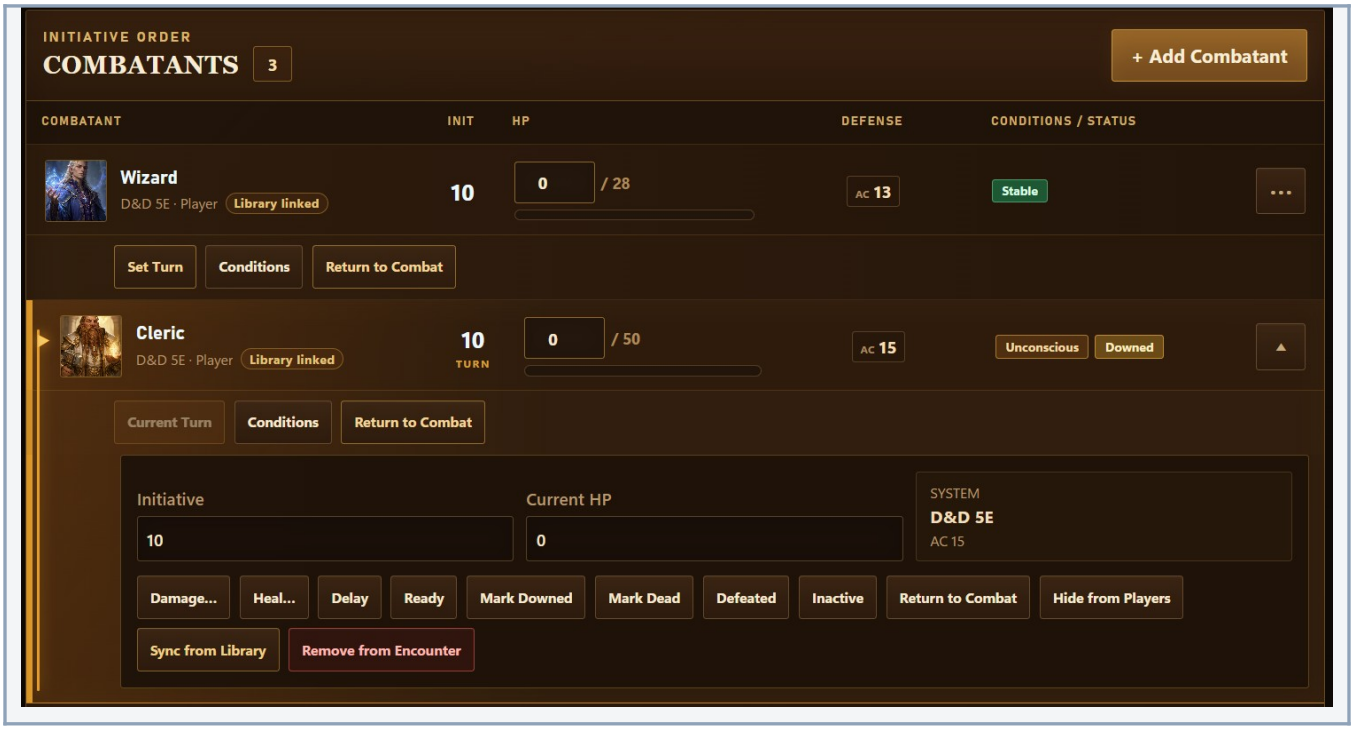


Figure 12 — Simplified combatant row and ... menu.

16. Player Display

The Player Display is a separate browser window intended for a second monitor, TV, or projector. It uses the same local browser profile as the DM Console for synchronization.

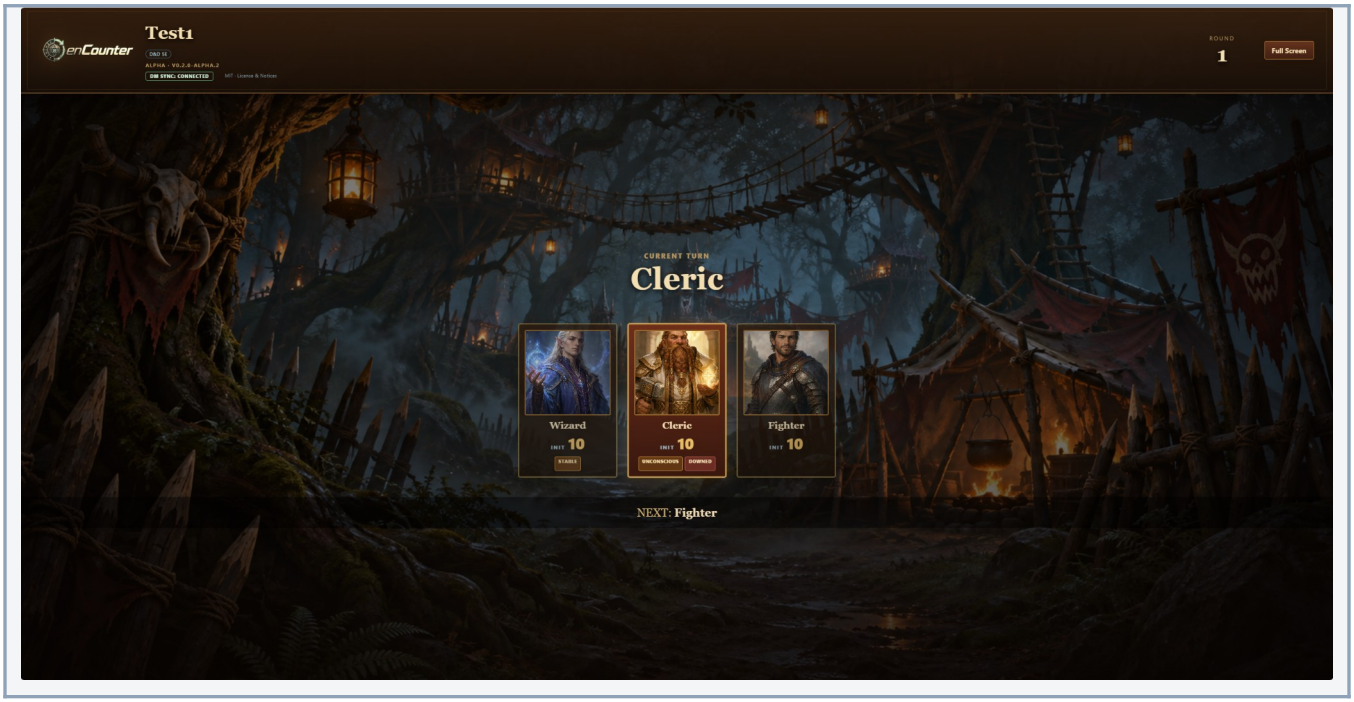


Figure 13 — Player Display - Combat Mode.

16.1 Display Controls

- Open Display — open/connect the player-facing window.
- Show Scene — display the Scene presentation.
- Show Combat — display combat initiative/presentation.
- Send to Standby — show the privacy screen without ending the encounter phase.

16.2 Standby

Standby hides encounter information and player-visible timers while the DM makes private changes.

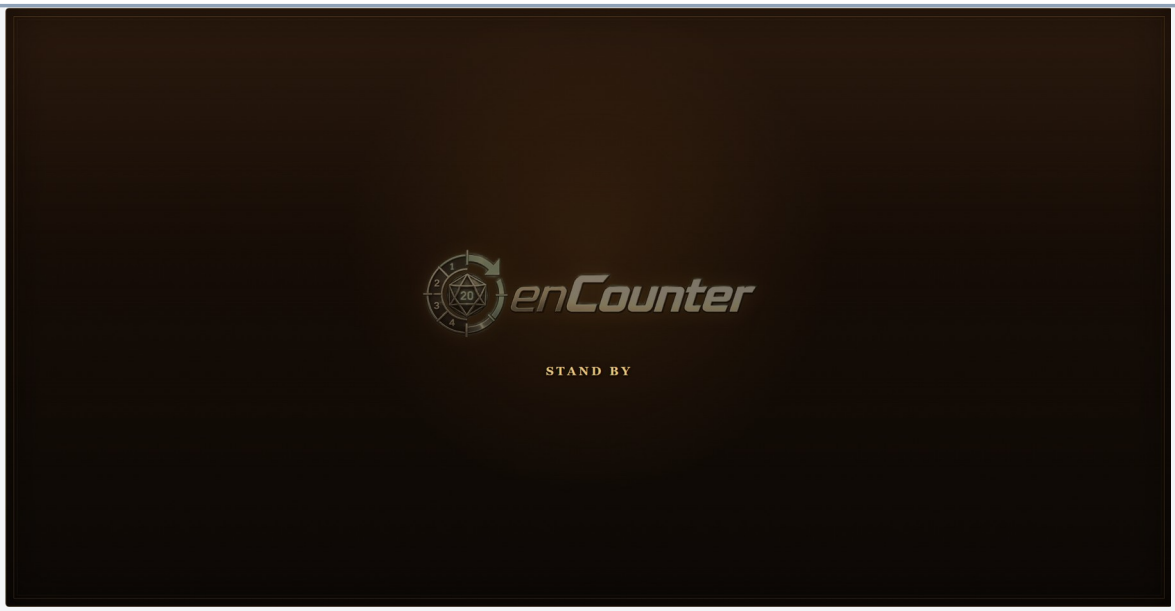


Figure 14 — Player Display - Standby.

16.3 Scene

Scene presentation shows the configured Scene background and can show a player-visible timer without exposing initiative/combat information.



Figure 15 — Player Display - Scene Mode.

16.4 Combat

Combat presentation shows the combat background and visible initiative information. The current visible combatant is highlighted and automatically centered as the turn advances.

16.5 Hidden combatants

Hidden combatants remain fully visible to the DM but are completely omitted from the Player Display until revealed.

> **SAME BROWSER PROFILE:** DM Console and Player Display should use the same browser profile. Do not mix a normal DM window with a private/incognito Player Display.

17. Scene and Combat Presentation

Reusable encounter setup can store separate Scene and Combat backgrounds. Scene is intended for roleplay/exploration presentation; Combat is intended for initiative play.

Run separates Player Display presentation from encounter phase. The DM can use Show Scene or Show Combat when needed without treating display visibility itself as initiative state.

- Scene Mode / Show Scene: roleplay artwork; no initiative presentation.
- Start Combat: enters live combat phase and establishes the current turn.
- Show Combat: shows combat presentation on Player Display.
- End Combat: returns encounter phase toward scene/non-combat operation as configured.

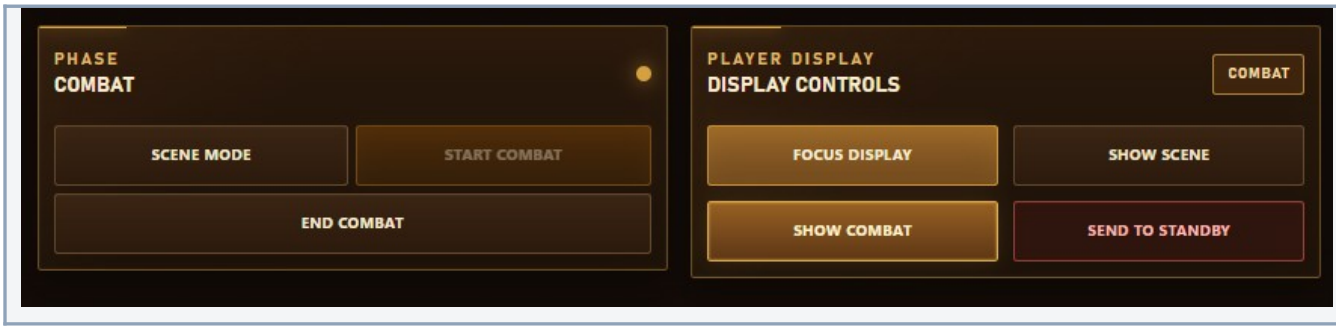


Figure 16 — Scene and Combat Controls.

18. Visual Timer

The Timer is independent of initiative and can be used in Scene or Combat. The prepared configuration belongs to the encounter template; the runtime checkpoint belongs to the live session.

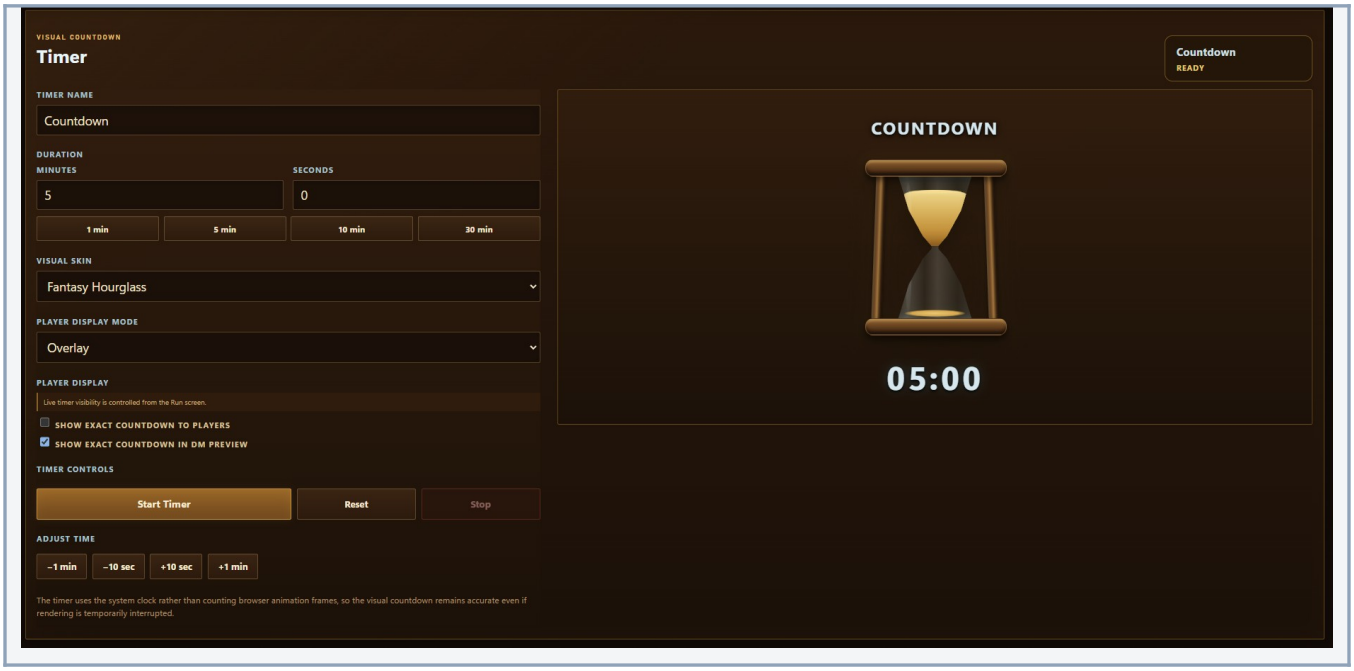


Figure 17 — Timer configuration and preview.



Figure 18 — Timer - Visual Skins

18.1 Prepared configuration

- Timer Name
- Minutes / Seconds
- Visual skin, including Fantasy Hourglass, Candle, or Sci-Fi Pixel Sequence
- Player Display mode such as Overlay, Featured, or Focus
- Show timer to players
- Show exact countdown to players
- Show exact countdown in DM preview

18.2 Live controls

Start, Pause, Resume, Reset, Stop, and time-adjustment controls are available. The Run workspace also displays the current timer name, status, countdown, and progress so the DM can operate a prepared timer without leaving Run.

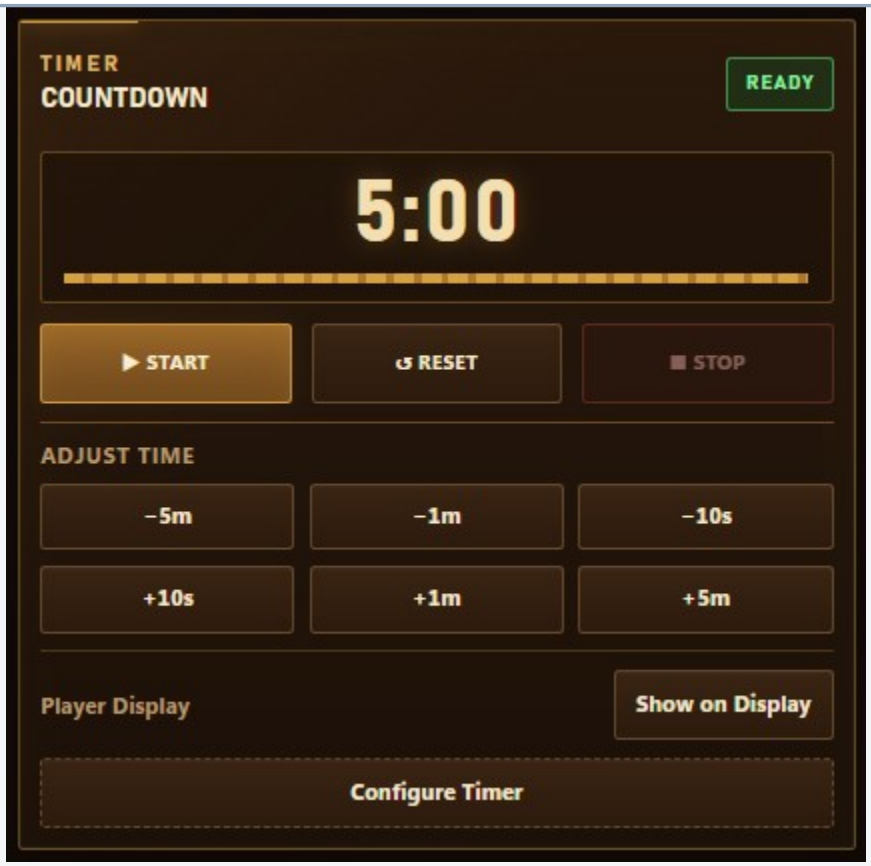


Figure 19 — Timer - Run Encounter Controls.

18.3 Template versus runtime timer state

Loading a reusable template restores the prepared Timer setup in a fresh Ready state. Running/paused/completed state and current remaining time are not written back into the reusable template. A separate runtime checkpoint can restore a live timer after an application restart when appropriate.

19. Audio, Soundscape, and Sound Cues

Audio remains local to the DM computer. The Player Display is visual-only, which avoids duplicate playback and browser audio synchronization issues.

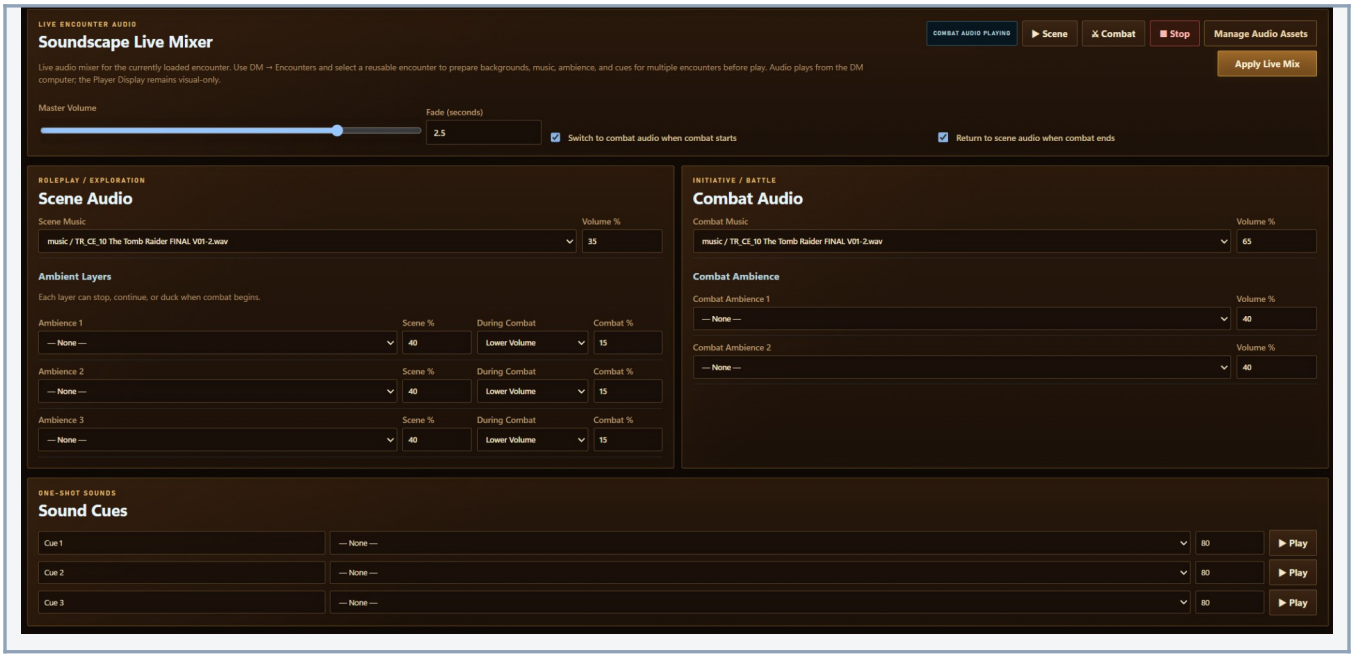


Figure 20 — Audio / Soundscape configuration.

19.1 Import audio

Supported formats include MP3, OGG, WAV, and FLAC. Store/import files under the matching assets/sounds folder.

19.2 Scene audio

Configure optional Scene music and ambience layers. Each Scene ambience layer can be configured to Stop, Continue, or Lower Volume when combat begins.

19.3 Combat audio

Configure Combat music/ambience and whether Start Combat should switch automatically. The setup can optionally return to Scene audio when combat ends.

19.4 Sound Cues

Up to three prepared one-shot cues can be assigned to a reusable encounter. After the setup is saved/applied, configured cues appear in Run under Sound Cues for immediate triggering during Scene or Combat.

19.5 Browser audio behavior

USER GESTURE MAY BE REQUIRED: Browsers can block autoplay. If audio does not start, use a Scene/Combat audio control or Sound Cue again. Confirm the file exists and the relevant track/master volume is above zero.

20. Saving, Persistence, Backups, and Recovery

20.1 Browser IndexedDB

The primary working database is browser IndexedDB. In the current Alpha line the database is named enCounterAlphaDB. Browser data lives outside the portable folder.

20.2 Automatic disk backups

When enabled, important saves can schedule JSON backups under data/backups/. Disk backups are an additional recovery layer; they are not the primary live database.

20.3 Template vs Saved Encounter State persistence

Reusable Templates preserve repeatable setup and reset transient combat state when loaded. Saved Encounter States preserve live progress for resuming a session. Use the correct save type deliberately.

20.4 Runtime timer persistence

The live timer uses a runtime checkpoint separate from reusable template Timer configuration. This allows restart recovery without contaminating the prepared encounter template with an old running countdown.

20.5 Export/import

Export Everything is the recommended portable JSON recovery copy for the browser database. User images/audio are separate local files and must be copied independently when moving installations.

21. Moving enCounter to Another Computer or USB

1. On the original computer, use Data & Tools → Export Everything.
2. Save the JSON somewhere safe, preferably outside the portable folder as well.
3. Use Exit enCounter so the local process releases the folder.
4. Copy the complete portable folder, including assets, to the destination computer or USB device.
5. Start enCounter on the destination computer.
6. Import/restore the Export Everything JSON if the browser database is not already present.
7. Verify portraits, backgrounds, and audio assets.

INDEXEDDB DOES NOT TRAVEL WITH THE FOLDER: Copying the portable folder moves files, not the browser profile/database. Use Export Everything when transferring to another computer or browser profile.

22. Exiting enCounter Correctly

Closing only the browser tab does not necessarily stop the packaged local server. Use the application shutdown control.

1. Finish the current action and wait for SAVED.
2. Click Exit enCounter.
3. Confirm when prompted.
4. Allow the final save/backup/shutdown request to complete.
5. Close the browser tab after shutdown completes.

After a clean shutdown, port 5500 should no longer have a LISTENING socket. TIME_WAIT or FIN_WAIT connections can briefly remain while Windows/Linux finishes normal TCP cleanup.

BEFORE MOVING OR DELETING THE FOLDER: Always use Exit enCounter first.

23. Recommended Game-Session Workflow

Before the session

1. Prepare/update reusable Characters and Compendium creatures.
2. Open Prepare → Encounters and create/select a Reusable Encounter Template.
3. Add template combatants.
4. Configure Scene/Combat backgrounds, Audio/Soundscape, Sound Cues, and prepared Timer settings.
5. Click Save Encounter Setup.
6. Open the Player Display and keep it on Standby while making private final adjustments.

During the session

1. In Run, load the Reusable Template or start a Quick Encounter.
2. Use Show Scene for roleplay/exploration presentation.
3. Start Scene audio and timers when desired.
4. When combat begins, Start Combat and show Combat presentation.
5. Use Previous/Next Turn and Active Turn Quick Actions during initiative.

6. Use Conditions, Recovery, Exhaustion, visibility, and Defeated/Return controls as needed.
7. Trigger Sound Cues from Run without leaving the encounter.

End of session

1. If the exact live situation must continue later, create/update a Saved Encounter State.
2. Optionally use Export Everything for a milestone backup.
3. Wait for SAVED and click Exit enCounter.

24. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to check
Port 5500 is already in use	A compatible existing enCounter instance should be reused gracefully. If startup still fails, close stale enCounter/python processes and retry.
Browser shows an old interface	Confirm you launched the new release folder. Try Ctrl+R, then Ctrl+Shift+R. Do not clear IndexedDB/site data as a routine first step.
Player Display is disconnected	Use the same browser profile; keep the DM Console open; avoid mixing normal and incognito/private windows.
Player Display remains on Standby	Use Show Scene or Show Combat in Display Controls and confirm the display is connected.
Library entry not available in Run	Confirm the Library entry system matches the active encounter system and the correct category/filter is selected.
Compendium returns no results	Confirm internet access, use a creature-name search, and confirm the local launcher is the current Alpha 3 build.
Compendium works in development but not portable	Verify the current packaged launcher is running; older launcher/proxy builds had Compendium routing failures.
Audio does not start	Browser user gesture may be required; confirm file, master volume, track volume, and output device.
Template loads without media	Saved setup stores media references, not file bytes. Confirm the referenced assets exist in the portable assets folder.
Windows says folder is in use	Use Exit enCounter; if necessary check Task Manager for a stale enCounter.exe/python process.
Linux permission denied	Run chmod +x enCounter, then ./enCounter.
Data missing on another computer	Browser IndexedDB does not travel with the folder;

	restore an Export Everything backup.
D&D player hit 0 HP but an NPC did not enter death saves	Automatic Downed/death-save behavior is limited to Type = Player. NPC/enemy recovery is DM-controlled by design.

Appendix A — System Profiles

Profile	Key behavior
Generic	Defense / Perception / Speed baseline.
SWSE	REF / FORT / WILL, Perception, Speed, Condition Track; Alpha 3 manual recovery-state support.
D&D 5E	AC, structured Conditions, Exhaustion 0–6, D&D Player Downed/Death Save automation.
Custom	Four configurable stat labels.

Appendix B — D&D 5E Condition Reference

- Blinded
- Charmed
- Deafened
- Frightened
- Grappled
- Incapacitated
- Invisible
- Paralyzed
- Petrified
- Poisoned
- Prone
- Restrained
- Stunned
- Unconscious

Exhaustion is tracked separately from the condition list at levels 0–6.

Appendix C — Data and File Reference

Item	Typical location / purpose
Working browser database	IndexedDB: enCounterAlphaDB — primary live data.
Automatic backups	data/backups/ — disk recovery copies.
Exports/imports	data/exports/ and data/imports/ where used.
Compendium cache	data/cache/compendium/ — cached provider index/detail data.
Portraits	assets/portraits/...
Backgrounds	assets/backgrounds/...
Audio	assets/sounds/music, ambience, sfx, custom.
Reusable Templates / Saved States	Browser database records and JSON backup/export representation.
Runtime Timer checkpoint	Browser/runtime persistence separate from reusable Timer configuration.

Appendix D — License, Privacy, Security, and AI Disclosure

enCounter v0.3.0-alpha.1 is distributed under the MIT License. The portable distribution includes LICENSE, THIRD_PARTY_NOTICES.md, PRIVACY.md, SECURITY.md, and AI_ASSISTANCE.md.

enCounter is local-first. The packaged server binds to 127.0.0.1 and is intended to keep encounter, Library, and campaign data on the local computer unless the user deliberately exports/copies/shares files.

The current application does not contain generative-AI functionality and does not intentionally send encounter, Library, or campaign data to an AI service. Generative AI tools were used as development assistance as disclosed in AI_ASSISTANCE.md.

Third-party names, systems, products, companies, and trademarks remain the property of their respective owners. Compatibility references do not imply endorsement, sponsorship, or affiliation.

Quick Reference — End of Session

Step	Recommended action
1	Wait for SAVED.
2	Save a live Encounter State if the exact session state must be resumed.
3	Optionally use Export Everything for a milestone backup.
4	Click Exit enCounter.
5	Wait for shutdown confirmation / local server stop.
6	Close the browser.
7	Only then move, replace, rename, or delete the portable folder.